

+1 347 244 8210 rasha.lama@hotmail.com www.rashalama.com						
Education		Awards & Scholarships				
2023–2026	Rhode Island School of Design (RISD) Master of Landscape Architecture I Providence, RI	2026	2026 LAF Olmsted Scholar Rhode Island ASLA , Merit Award Rhode Island ASLA Design Awards , “Planning & Analysis” Category Merit Award	4	Landscape Repositories: Mapping Social Narratives in Asbestos, QC Val-des-Sources, QC	Master of Landscape Architecture Thesis
2017–2021	McGill University Bachelor of Commerce, Major in Managing for Sustainability Montréal, QC	2025	Helen Hackney McColl Scholarship , RISD	18	Manglares Rey	Urban Systems Studio Project
		2024	Landscape Architecture Department RISD Graduate Commons Grant , RISD	30	Conimicut Point	CNC & Fabrication
		2023	Graduate Studies Department RISD Full-Tuition Scholarship	34	Vertebrae Cove	Drafting & Grading
Work Experience				38	Québec on Film	35mm Film Photography
9/2026–present	RISD Landscape Architecture Department Teaching Fellow (LDAR2201 Design Principles; LDAR2264 Representation I)	Publications				
		2026	Lama, Rasha, “Landscape Repositories: Mapping Post-Mining Narratives in Asbestos, QC Val-des-Sources, QC” (2026). <i>Masters Theses</i> . 1679. https://digitalcommons.risd.edu/masterstheses/1679			
3/2022–5/2023	Steven Holl Architects Business Development & Marketing Consultant New York, NY	2025	“A Sweater” in <i>Fugue Journal</i> (2024 Prose Contest Winner, \$1,000 prize)			
8/2021–3/2022	Studio GAIA Copywriter & Graphics Consultant Remote (New York, NY)	Qualifications Programs	Rhino Adobe Illustrator Adobe Photoshop Adobe InDesign ArcGIS Mastercam (CNC program) AutoCAD (in progress)			
Academic Experience						
4/2025–5/2026	Practice^(zine) , RISD Landscape Architecture Founding Editor-Designer Providence, RI					
01/2024–5/2026	RISD Landscape Architecture Department Teaching Assistant (LDAR2256 Design Foundations/Field Ecology; LDAR2217 Research Methods for Design; LDAR2201 Design Principles; LDAR226G Research, Theory, Design; LDAR228G Thesis Studio; LDAR3219 Mapping the Invisible)	Personal	Special Delivery (Substack newsletter) Film photography (a selection) Creative nonfiction (a selection)			
		Languages	English (native) Arabic (native, but needs love) French (basic, but also needs love)			

Title Landscape Repositories: Mapping Social Narratives in Asbestos, QC Val-des-Sources, QC

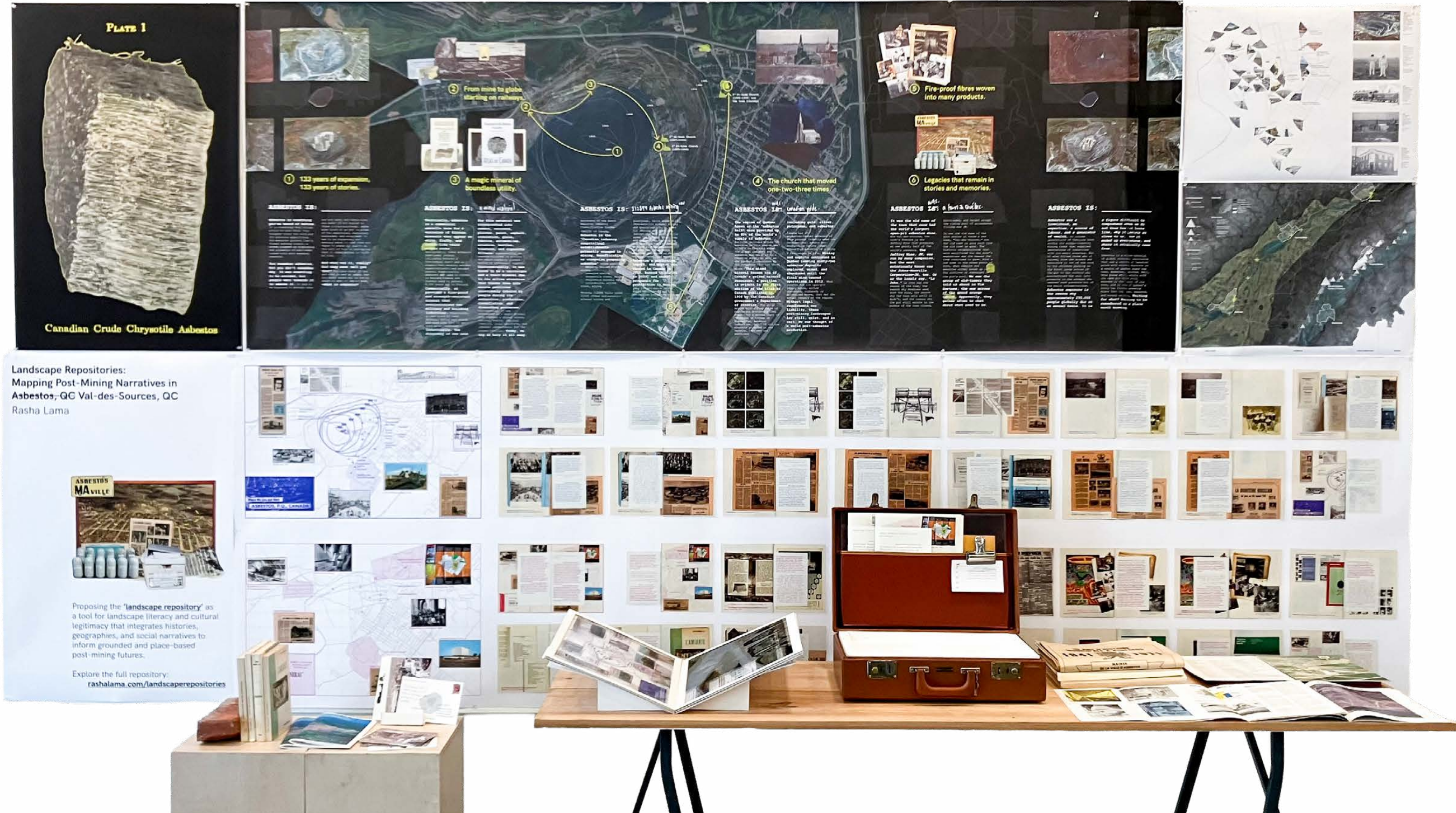
Advisor Suzanne Mathew
Project Master of Landscape Architecture Thesis

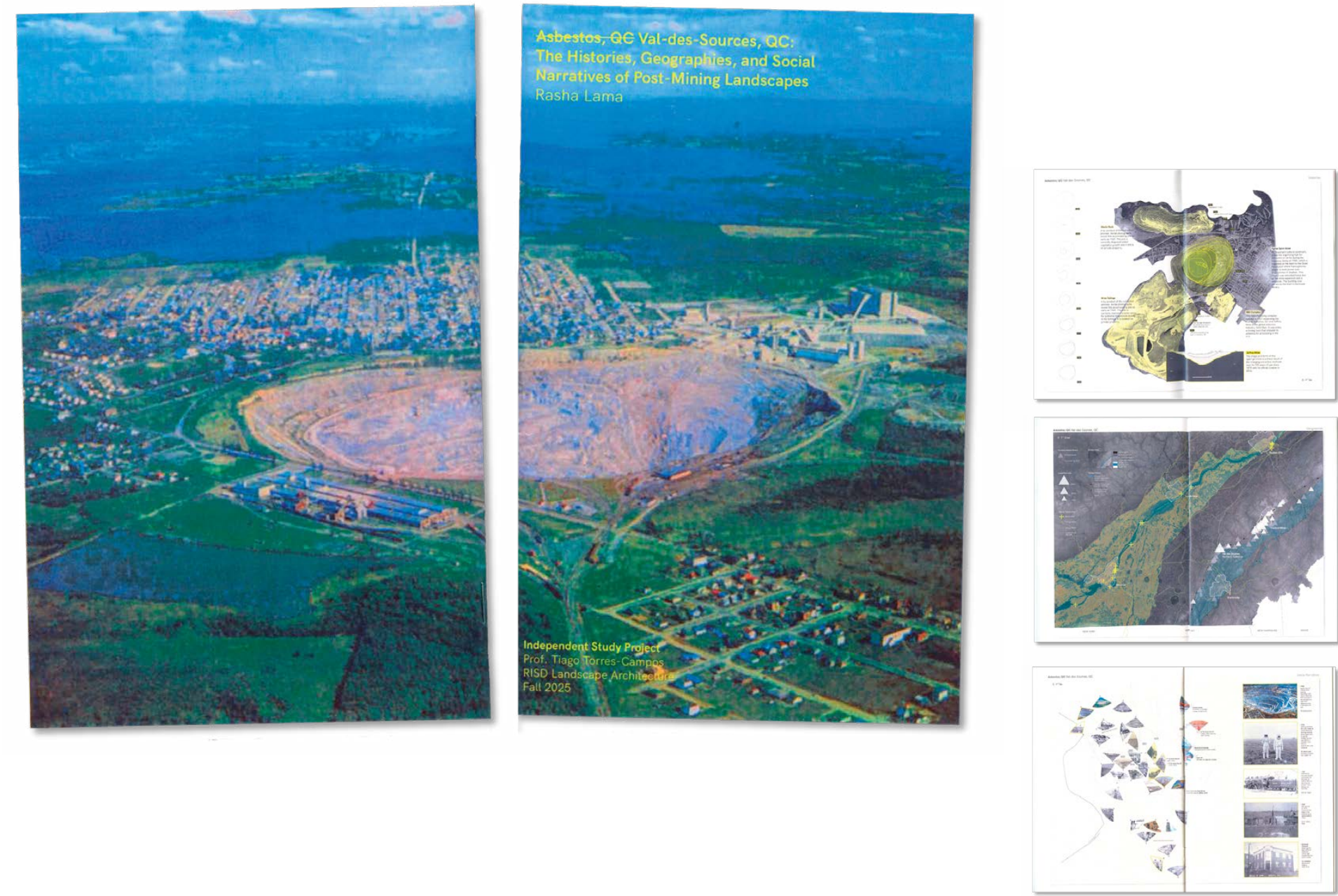
Statement Val-des-Sources, Québec (formerly Asbestos, QC) is a place whose extraction legacies and material histories are deeply interwoven into its contemporary economy and cultural landscape. The centre of town is the Jeffrey Mine, once the world's largest open-pit asbestos mine that is deep enough to hide the Eiffel Tower entirely. Ceased in 2012, the 130-year-old Jeffrey Mine and sixty-one other Québec asbestos sites once supplied about 80% of the world's asbestos.

This work proposes the 'landscape repository' as a tool for landscape literacy and cultural legitimacy that integrates histories, geographies, and social narratives through archival mining to inform place-based post-mining futures. Exploring various forms of storytelling through multi-medium interactive tools, this work includes:

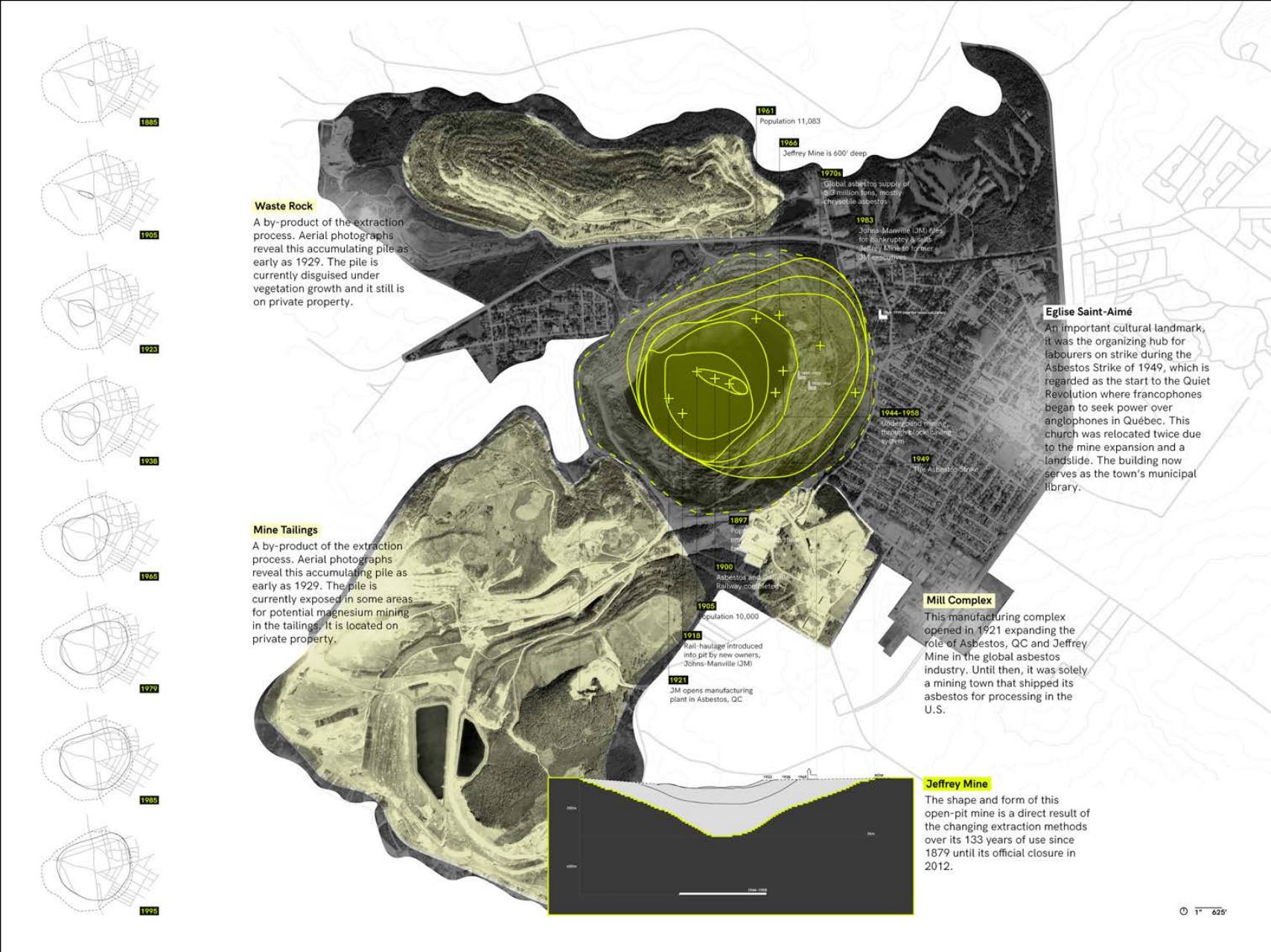
- 1/ a 52-pg landscape research booklet;
- 2/ a video and drawing mapping memory and asbestos' various understandings
- 3/ a physical landscape repository containing a site model, mapping plate, and narrative atlas with archival facsimile.

For access to the full thesis book, view the 186pg publication here: <https://digitalcommons.risd.edu/masterstheses/1679/>

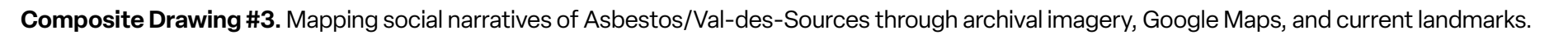




Research Publication. Fifty-two-paged research document including writing, drawings, photographs, and archival material.



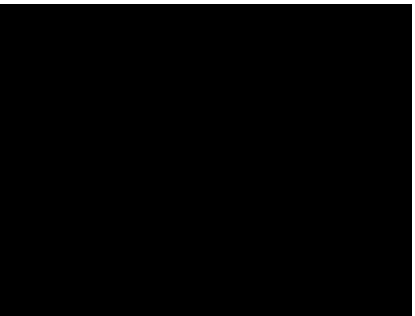
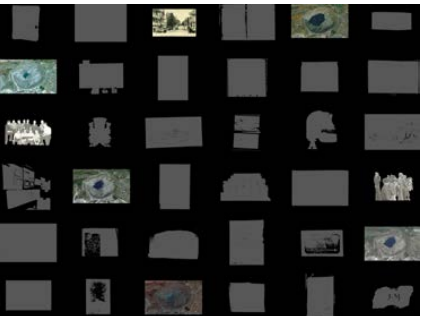
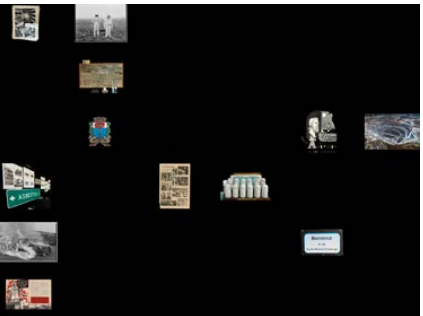
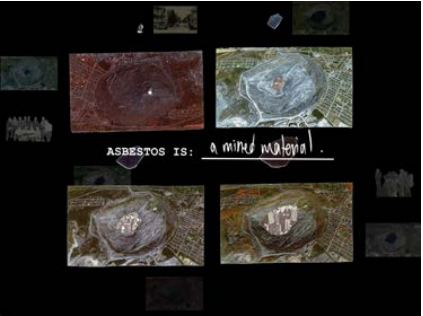
Composite Drawing #1. Historical timeline through the Jeffrey Mine's expansion alongside the current landscape's spatial mining evidence.

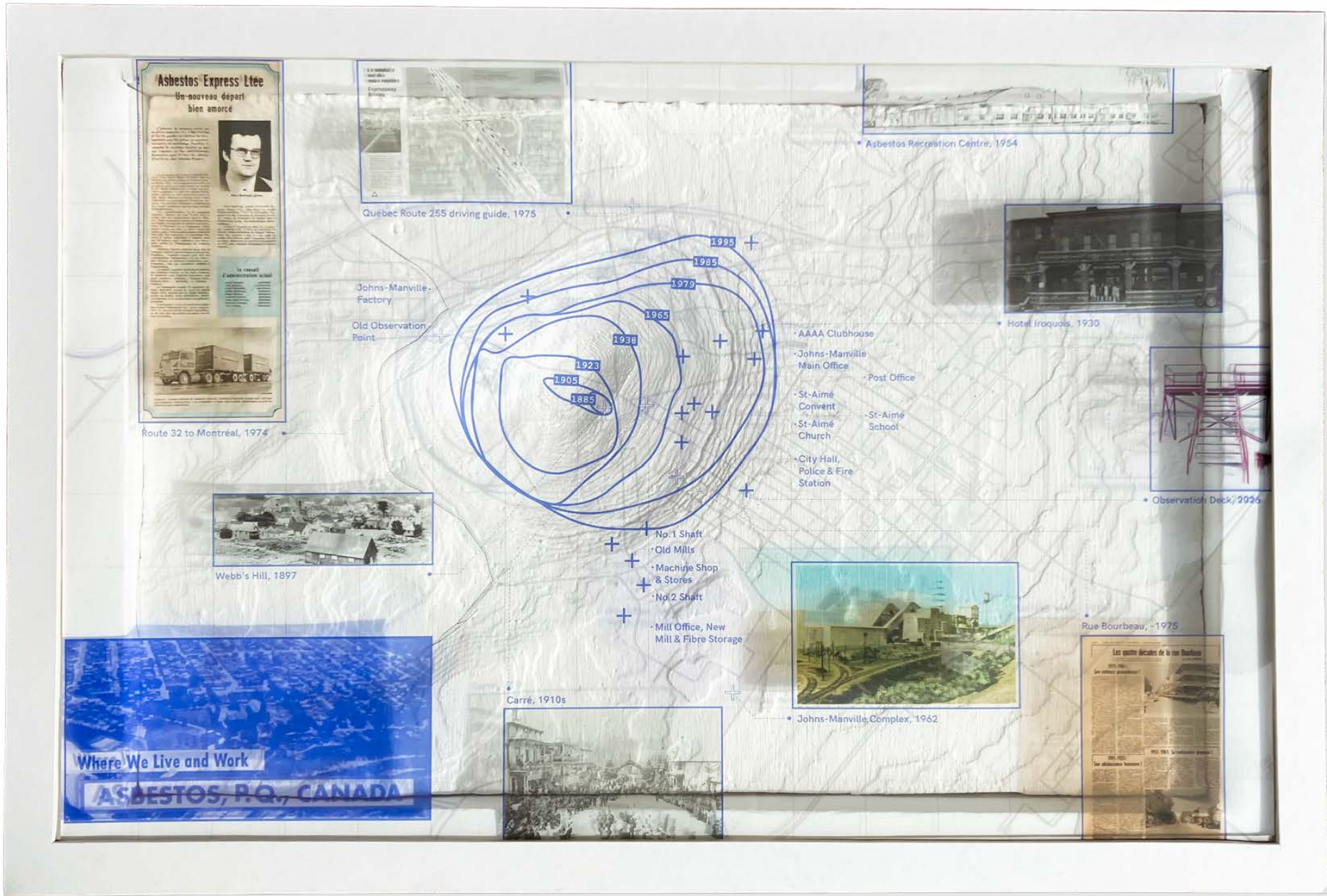




Asbestos Is: _____. Mapping memory through narrative writing and archival collaging inspired by the hippocampal index theory.

Video (1m40s). Watch [here](#).

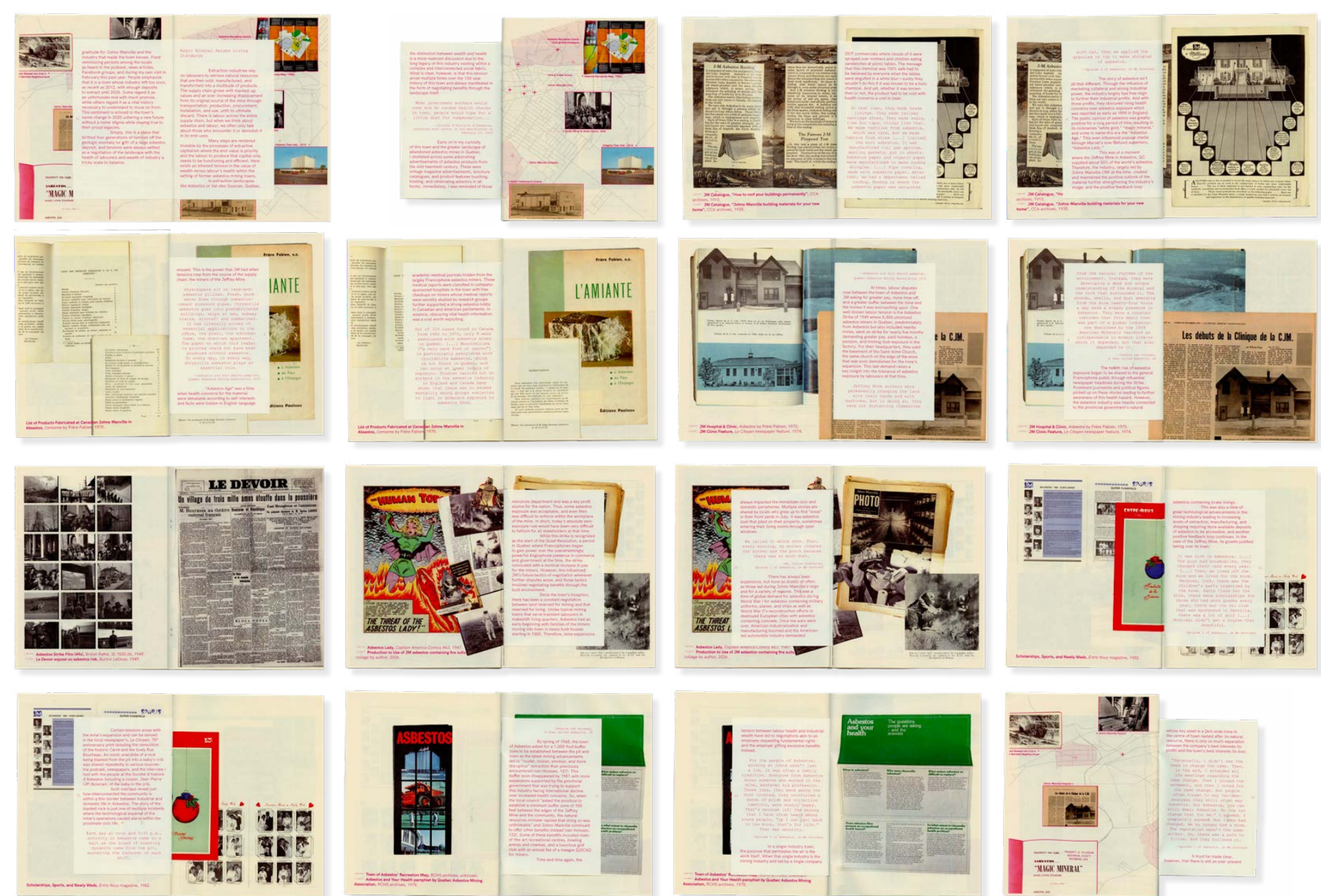




Property of J.M. A traveling exhibition project that explores the asbestos mining industry through a CNC site model (1:1200), mapping plate, and narrative atlas titled “Where We Live and Work,” title borrowed from a 1950 postcard. landscape writing.



Rasha Lama



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Title
Location

Manglares Rey
San Juan, Puerto Rico

Professors
Course

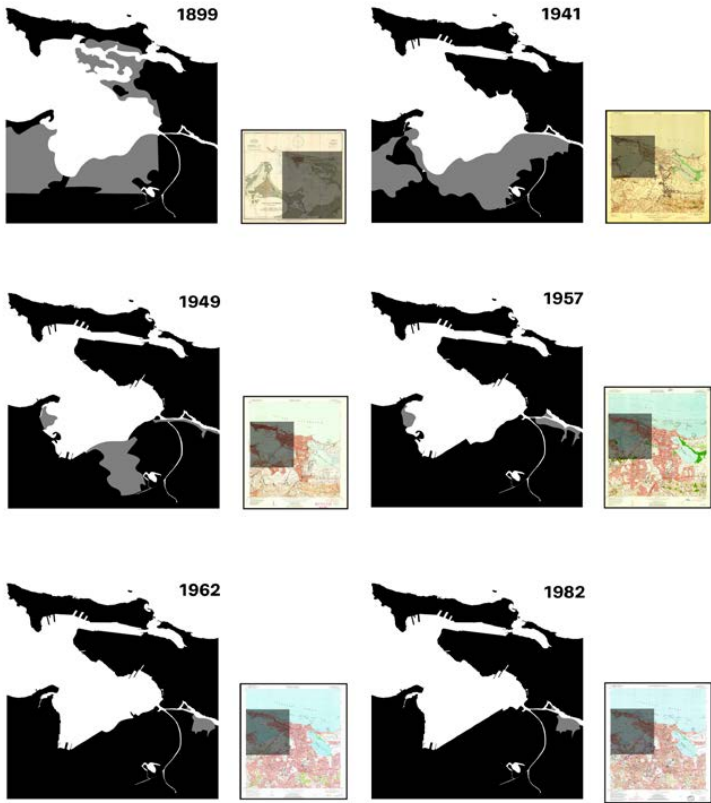
Emily Vogler & Manuel Cordero
LDAR 2205—Aqueous Terrain: Colonialism, Sovereignty & Climate Justice in San Juan

Statement

Manglares Rey proposes a resilient greenway network that integrates public access, recreation, and leisure with stormwater management, mobility infrastructure, and environmental education within the Hato Rey region of San Juan, Puerto Rico. Building on existing systems, the project seeks to reinforce and reimagine them with a unified goal: to establish public, socio-ecological programs that foster a resilient and connected urban landscape in the Río Piedras watershed.

Awards

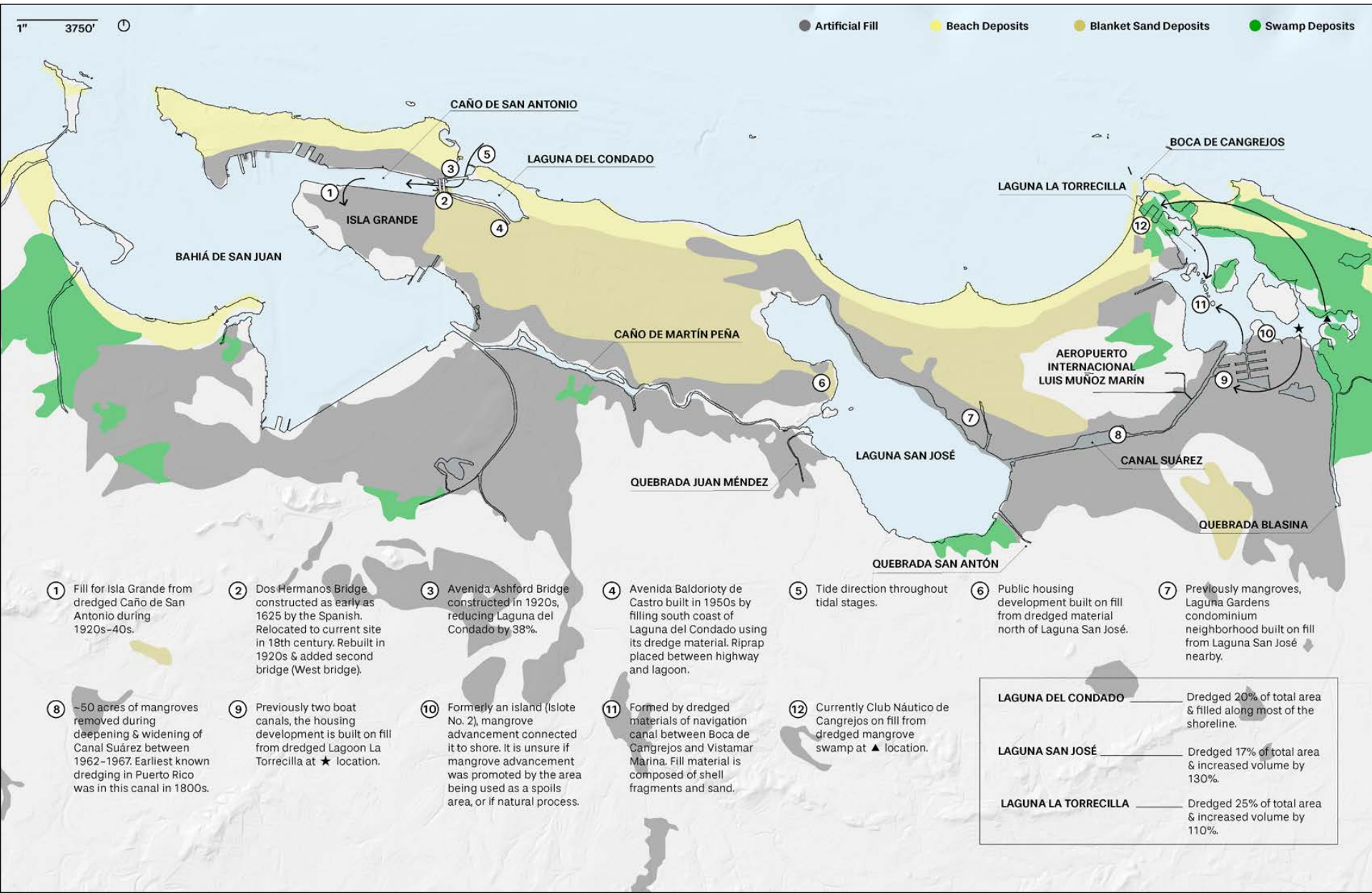
RIASLA Design Awards 2025: Merit Award under “Planning & Analysis” Category



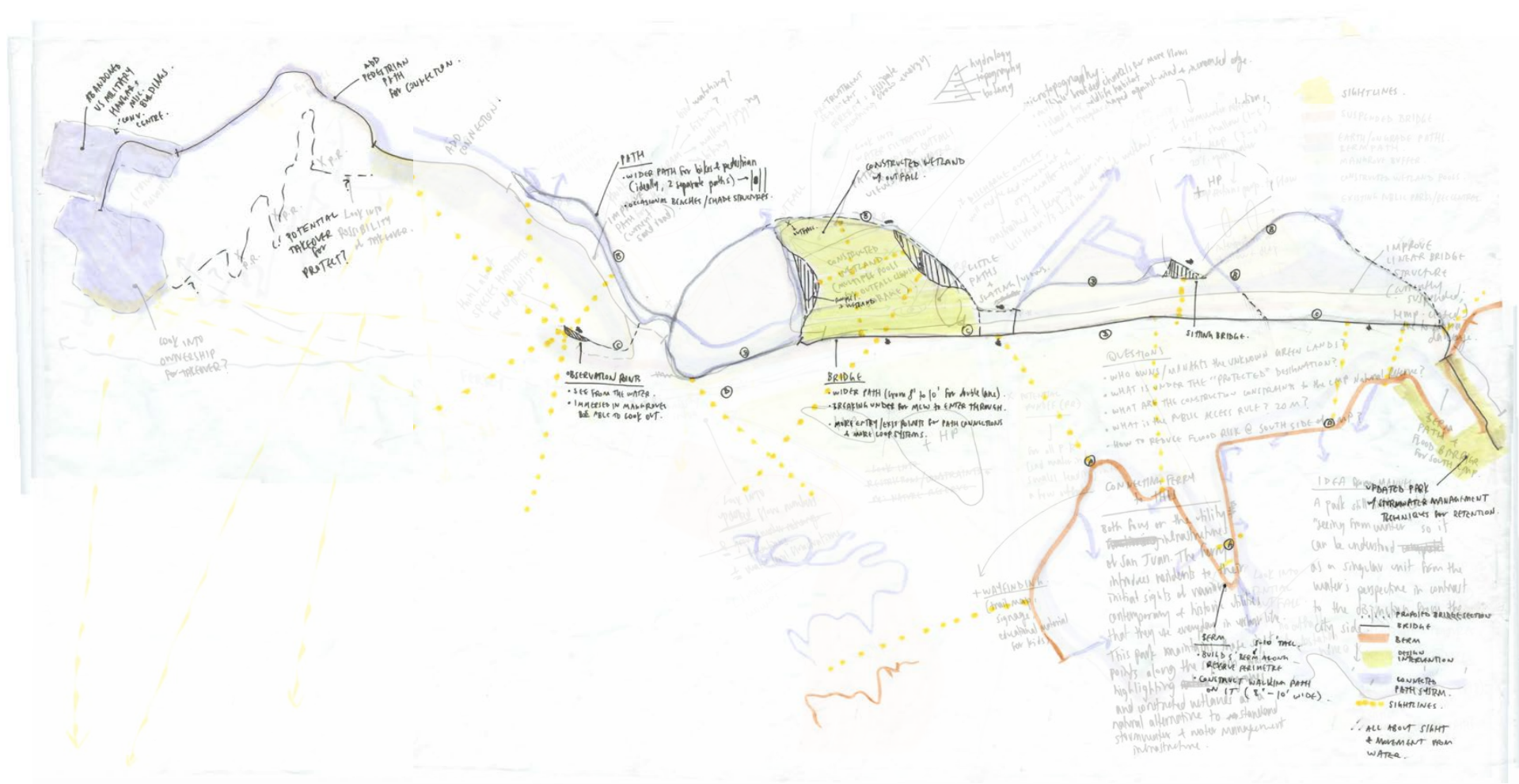
Mangroves disappearance in San Juan Bay since 1899. 75% of Puerto Rico's mangroves has been destroyed. 33% of the remaining mangroves exist in the San Juan Bay Estuary.



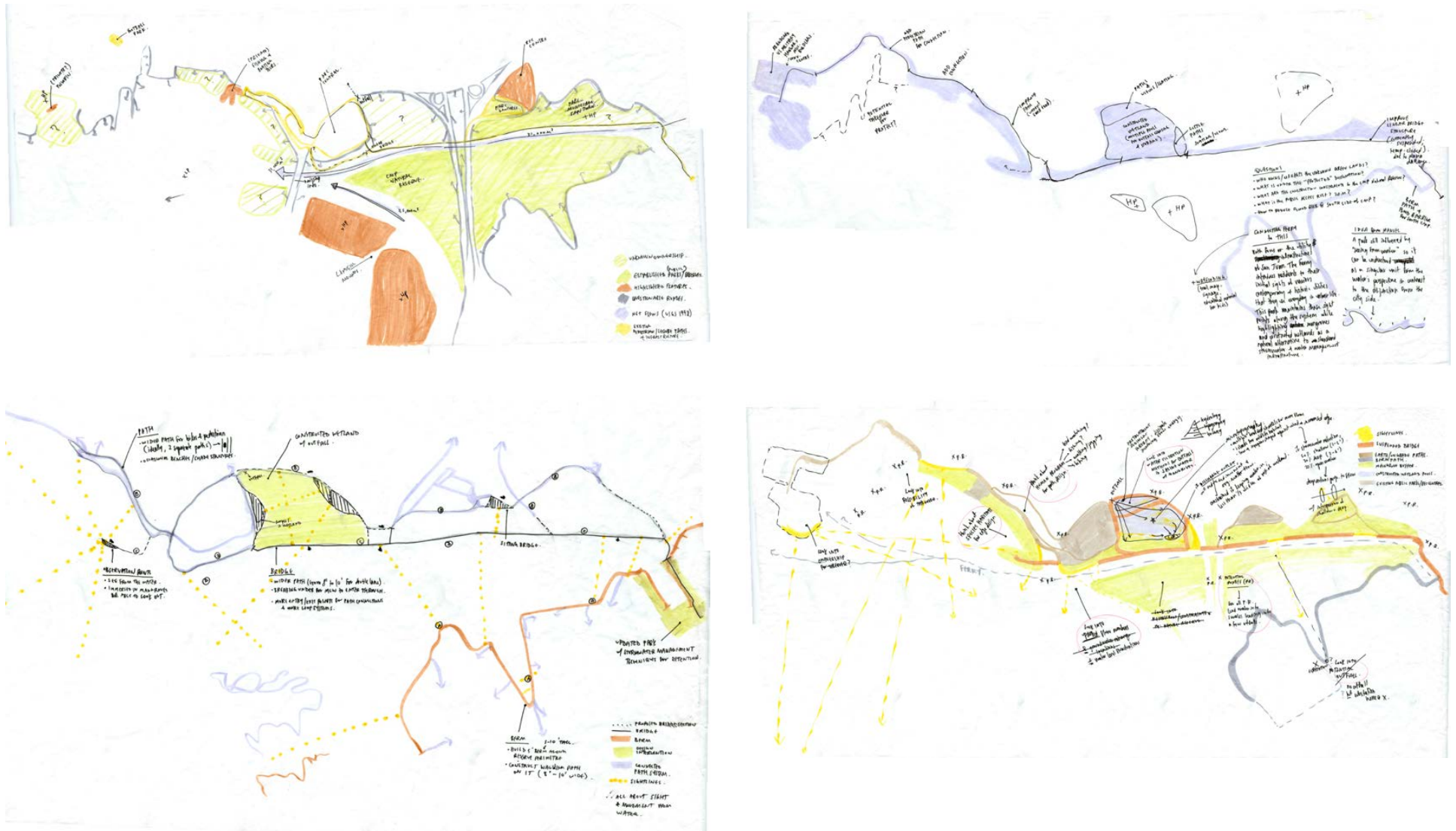
Rasha Lama



History of Fill & Dredge in San Juan's Lagoons. Mapping of historical sediment movements correlate with FEMA flood maps.



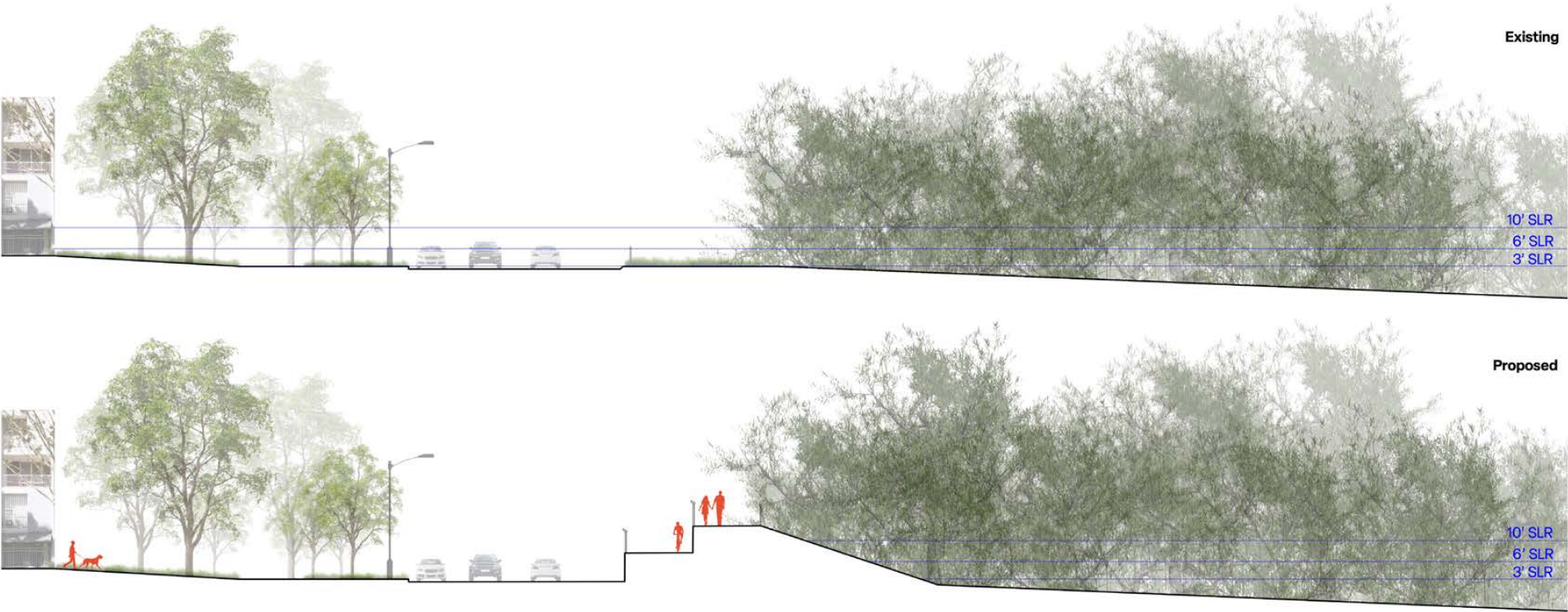
Design Process. Layers of trace to work through existing infrastructure, MS4 outfalls, viewsheds, and potential access points.



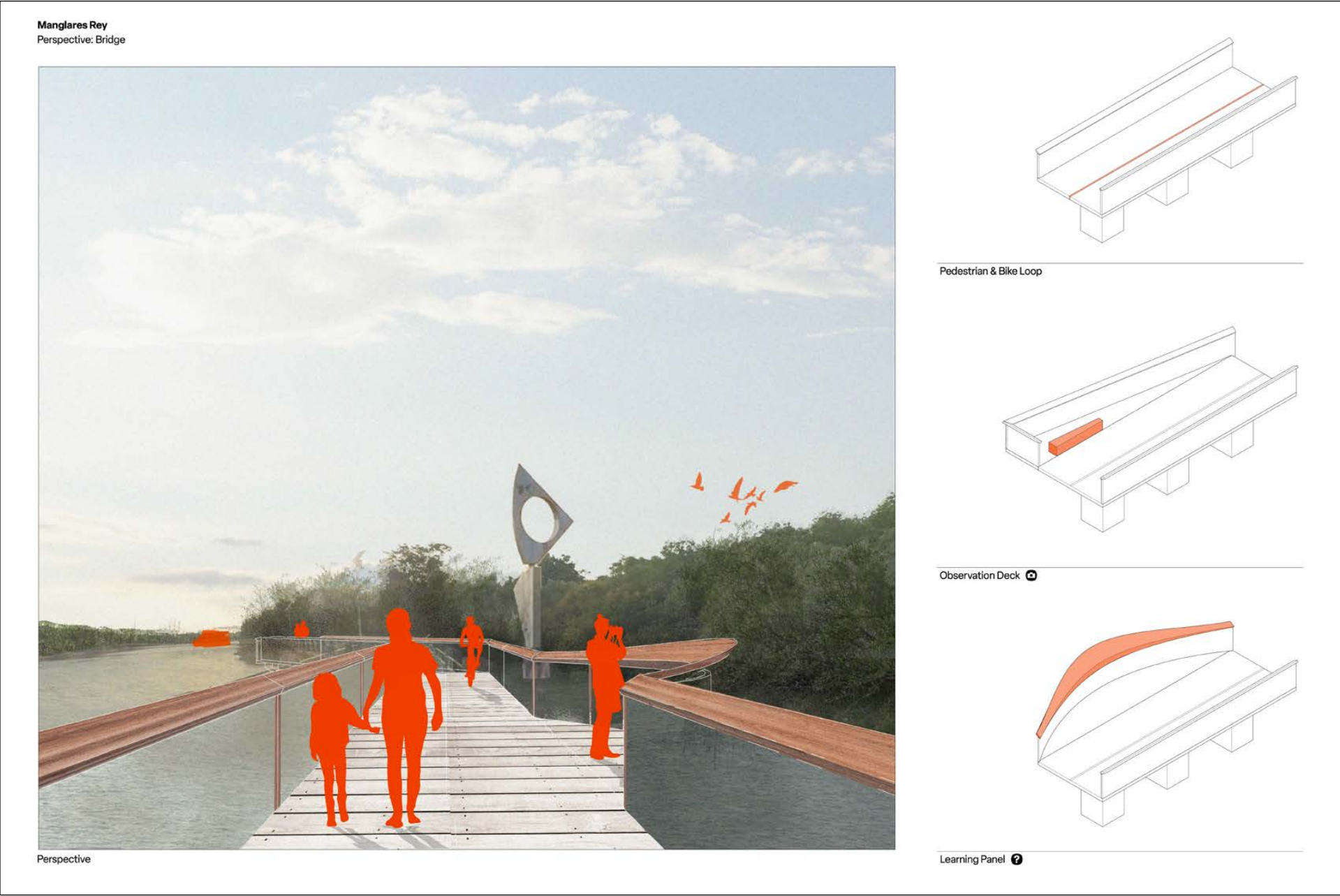
Clockwise starting from top-left: waterflow rate and institutional ownership; hydrology along potential path; notes and questions drawn on map; spatial plan revealed and clarified from underlying layers of trace.



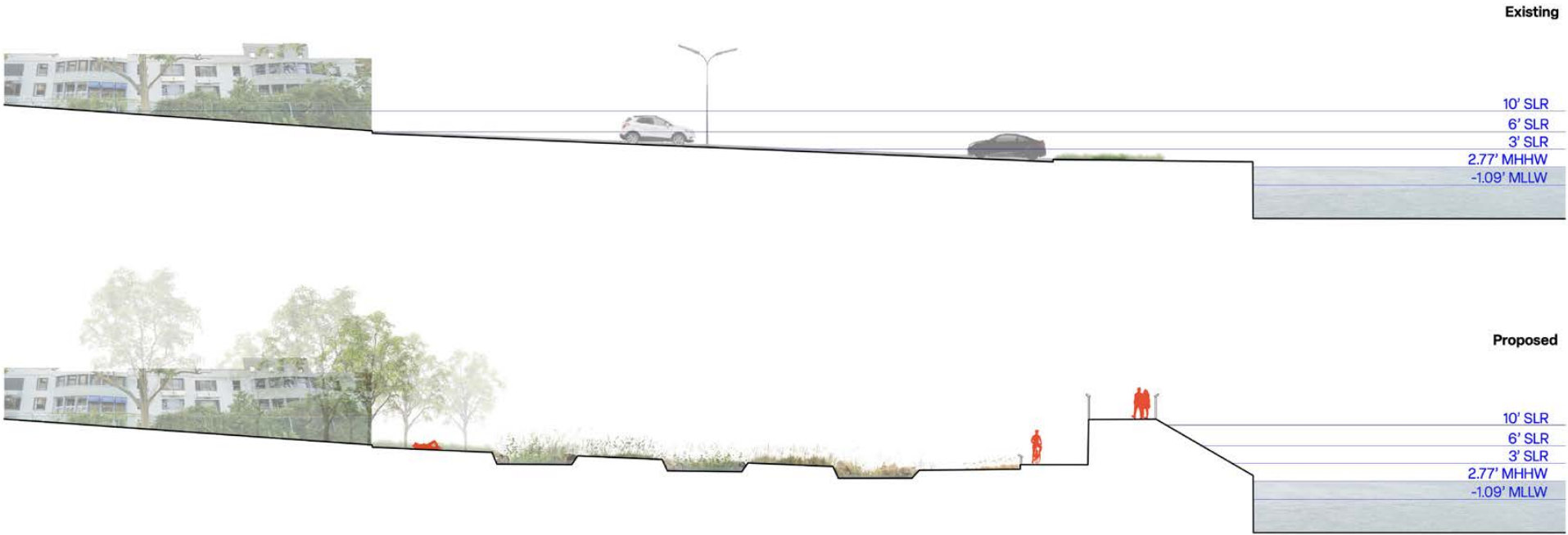
Berm Perspective. A neighbourhood access point to the berm connecting to the larger greenway loop.



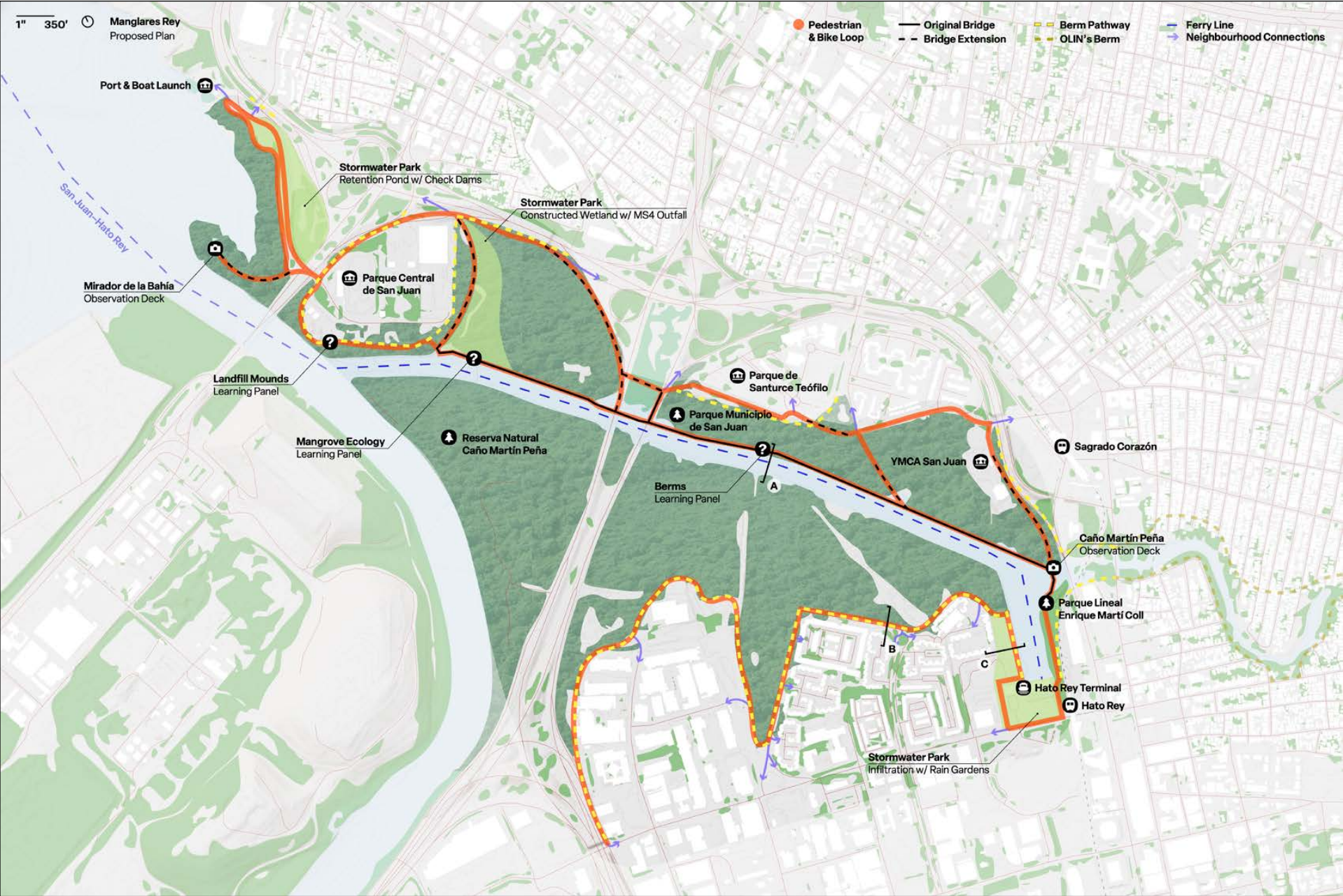
Section B. Extension of OLIN's flood barrier berms alongside the southern bank of Caño Martín Peña. This 3km berm system has multiple entry/exit ramps along its perimeter connecting pedestrians and bikers on the greenway loop with the local neighbourhoods nearby.



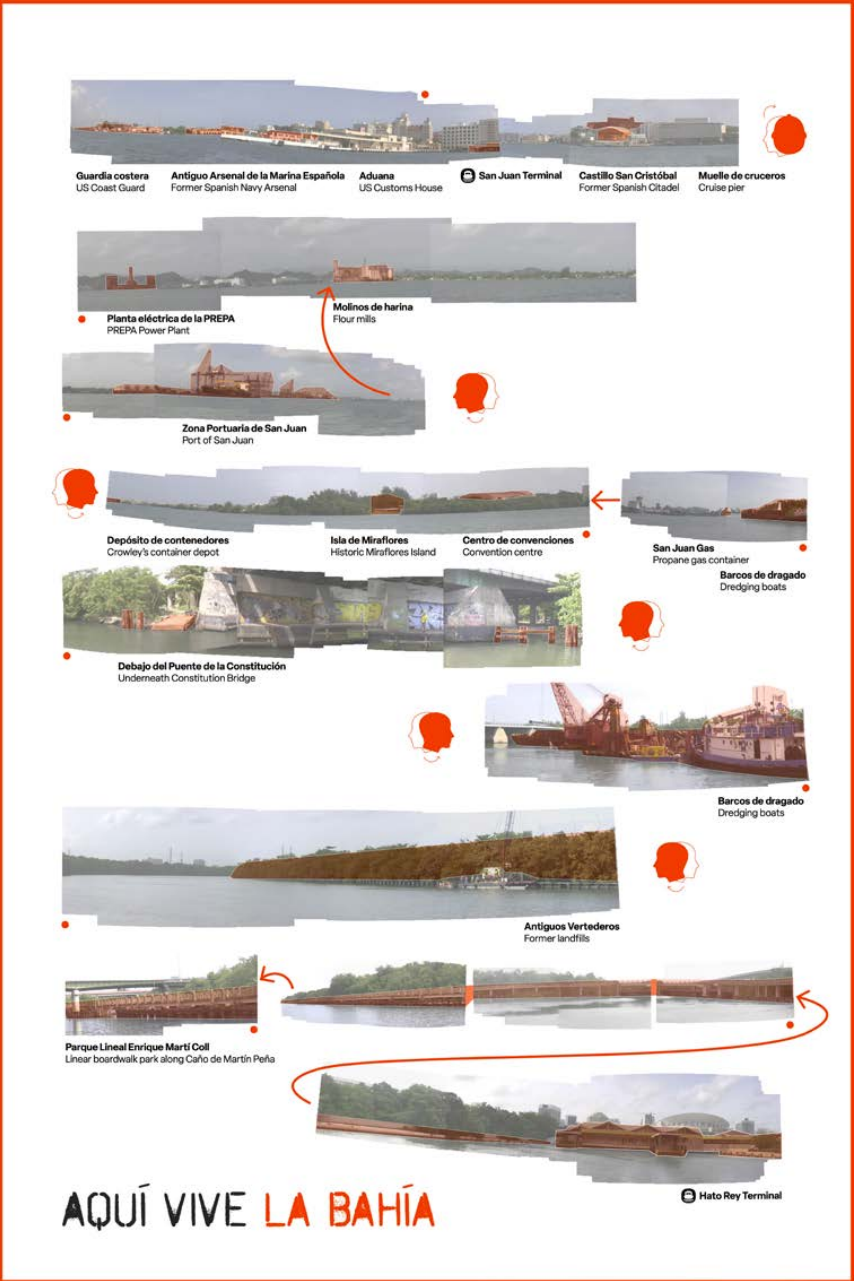
Bridge Perspective. Reconstruction of the currently closed Parque Lineal Enrique Martí Colli bridge with observation decks and learning panels.



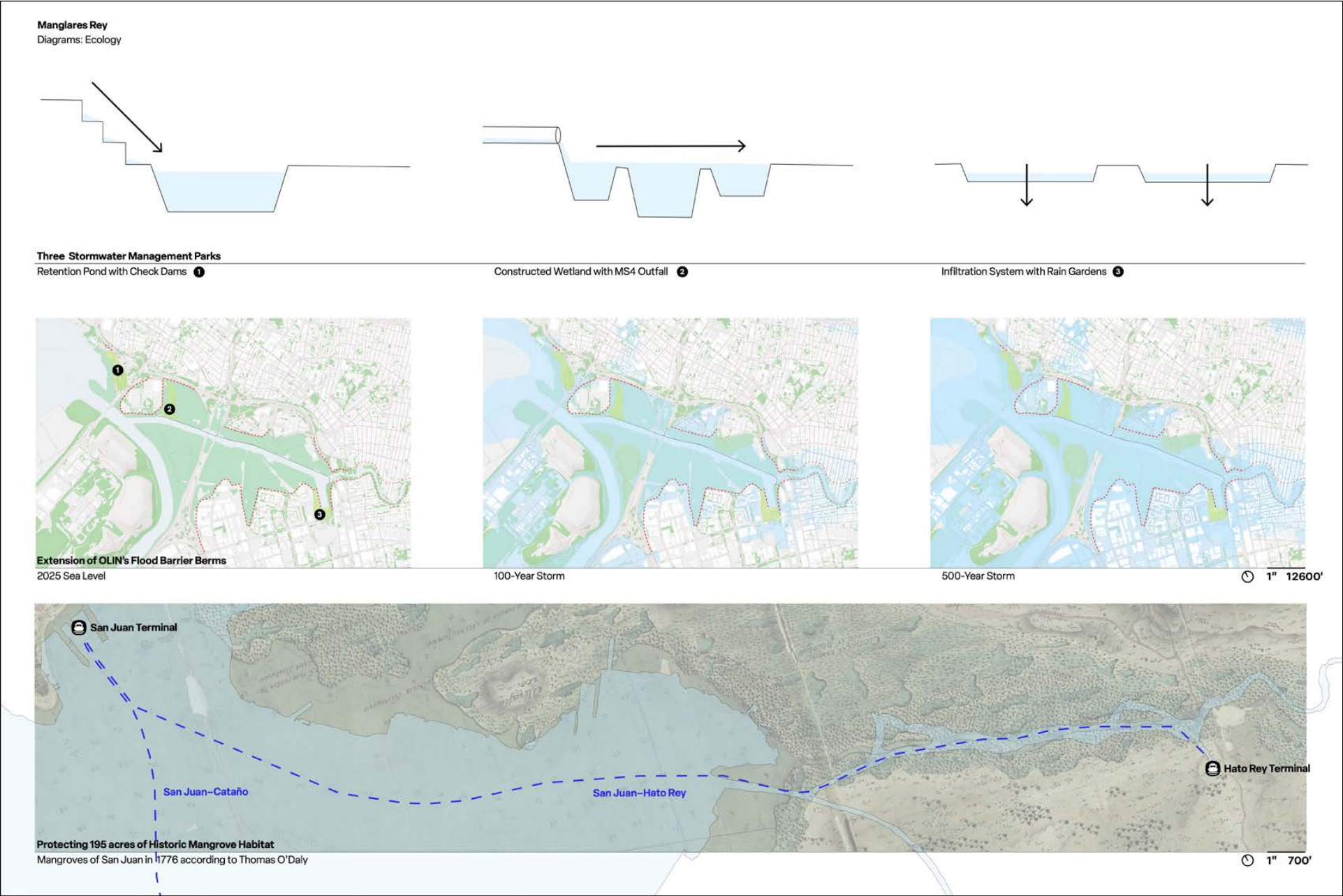
Section C. Readapting an abandoned parking lot near the Hato Rey ferry terminal into a meadow park. The series of rain gardens within the park allow for inland stormwater management while the berm system acts as a riverine flood barrier for the local residents.



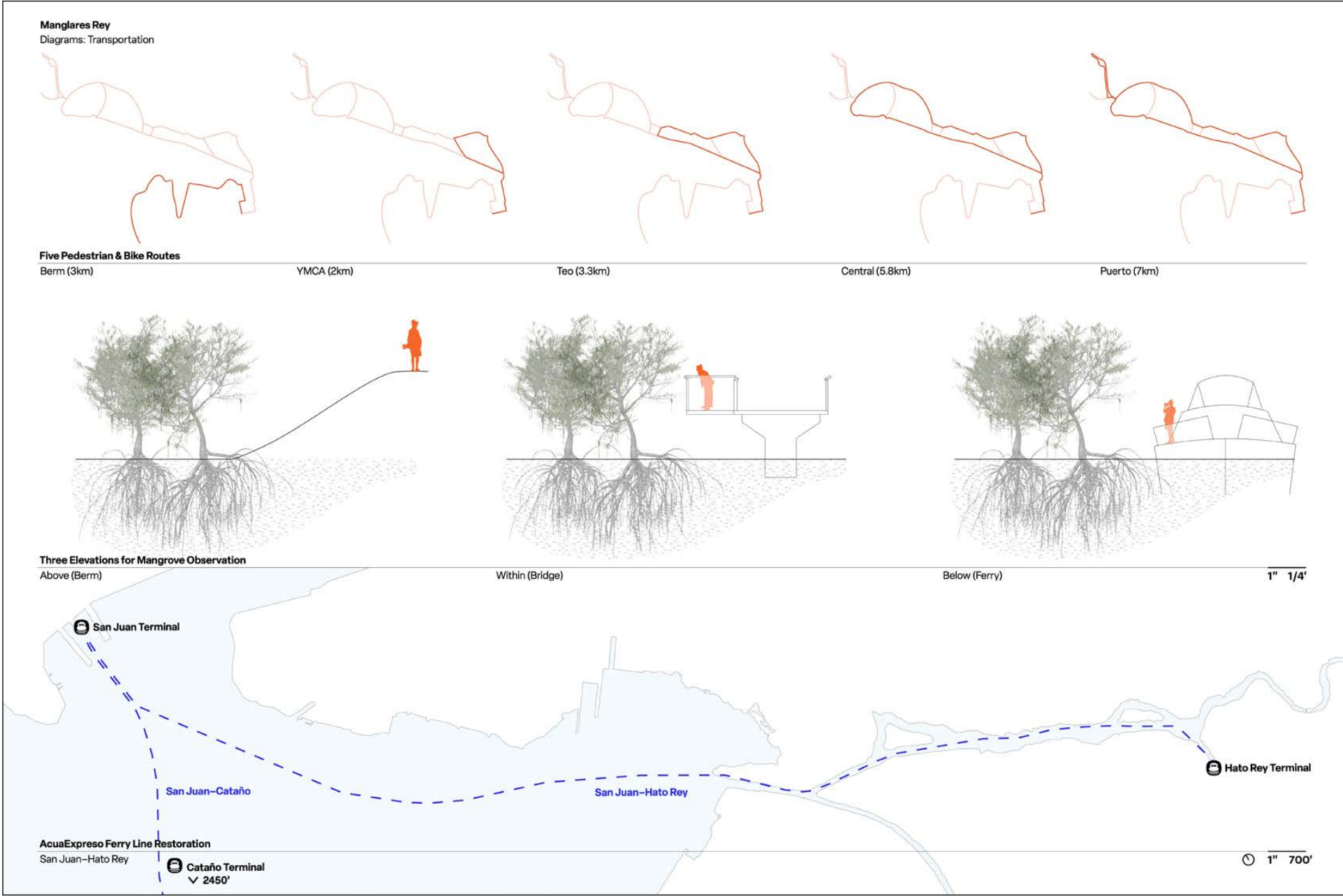
Site Plan. Connecting various existing public parks through a unified system of berms, bridges, and pathways alongside the reintroduced ferry service.



Ferry Guide. Providing a visual educational tool on the reintroduced ferry line contrasting contemporary features located in historic mangroves.



Ecology Diagrams. Various stormwater management techniques alongside the extension of OLIN's flood barrier berms for mangrove restoration.



Transportation Diagrams. Multiple routes, elevations, and forms of transportation exist within the proposed greenway network.

Title
Location

Conimicut Point
Warwick, Rhode Island

Professors
Course
Team

Evan Farley & James Dean
ARCH 3860—ReAssembly
Evan Friedman & Cristy Falcone

Statement

Inspired by Studio Anne Holtrop’s *in-situ* earth molds, this project developed a process-based method to preserve places actively undergoing flooding and disappearance through 3D scanning, Rhino meshes, Mastercam toolpaths, CNC milling, and paper mâché for an immersive gallery exhibit.



Gallery Display. Final “Ground Conditions” as a CNC foam mold and Hosho paper mâché copy alongside process and technique work samples.



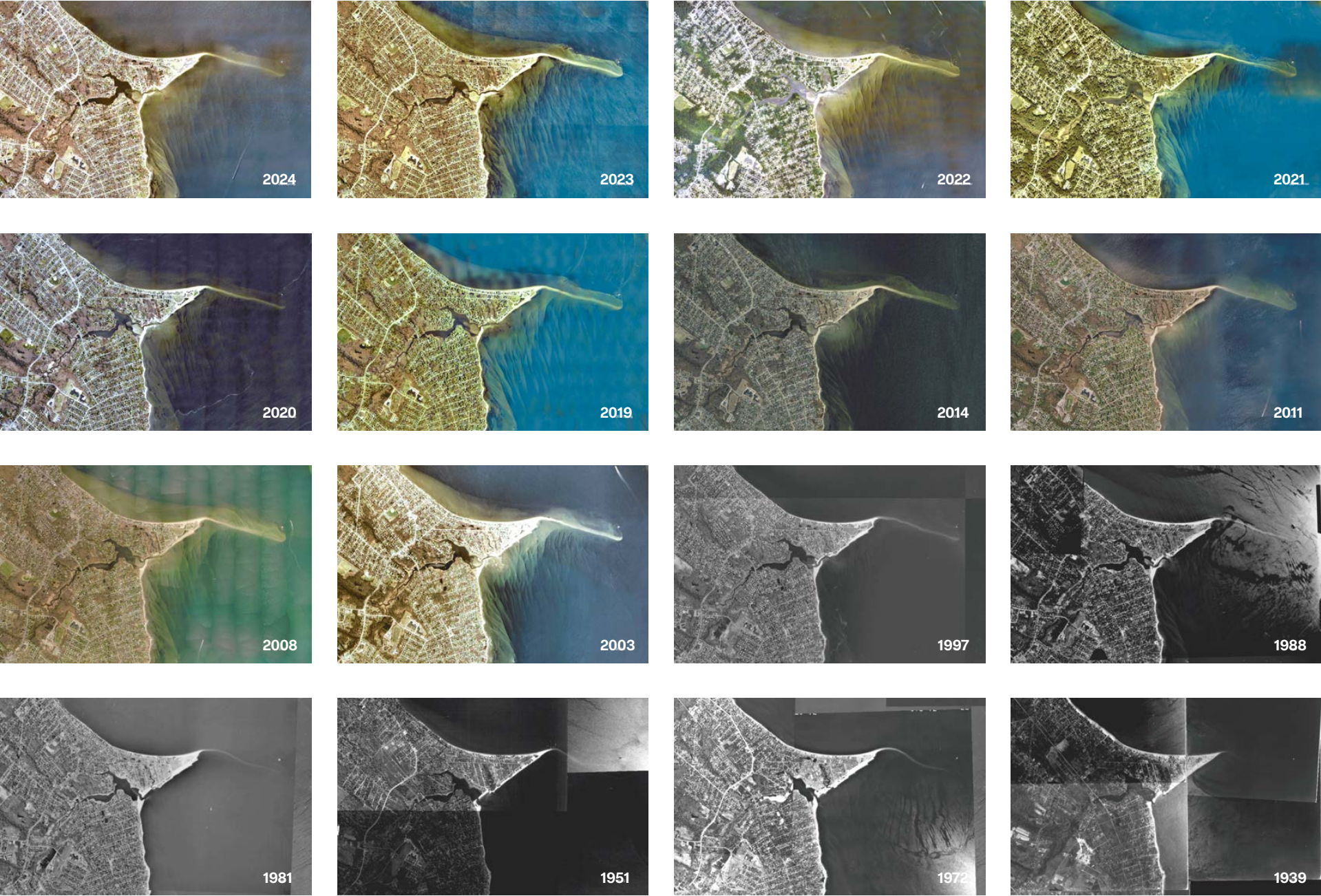
Process in Five Images (clockwise from top-left). Site visit with Evan & Cristy > CNC milling of Rhino mesh > Transporting milled foam > Laying Hosho sheets to create paper mâché on milled form > Drying paper for installation.



3D Scans to Rhino Mesh. Translating found conditions on Conimicut Point into topographical meshes for digital manipulation and CNC milling.



Multiscalar Video Installation. Projection of changing sediment forms at Conimicut Point on suspended paper mâché “Ground Conditions.”



Historic Sediment Changes. Site analysis of changing shoreline at Conimicut Point.

Title
Location

Vertebrae Cove
Providence, Rhode Island

Professors
Course

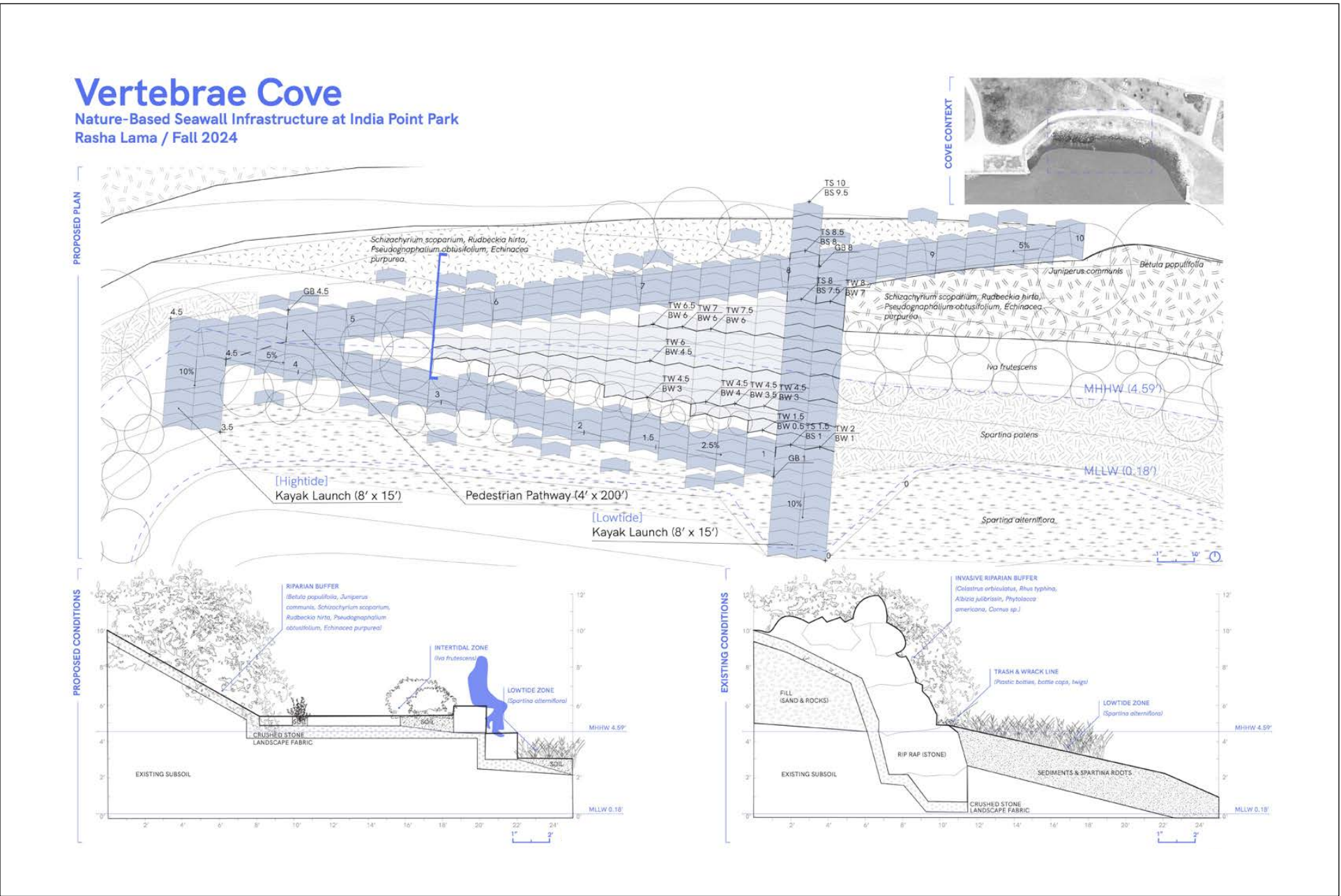
Sara Cohen & Adrian Fehrmann
LDAR 2266—Material Tests

Statement

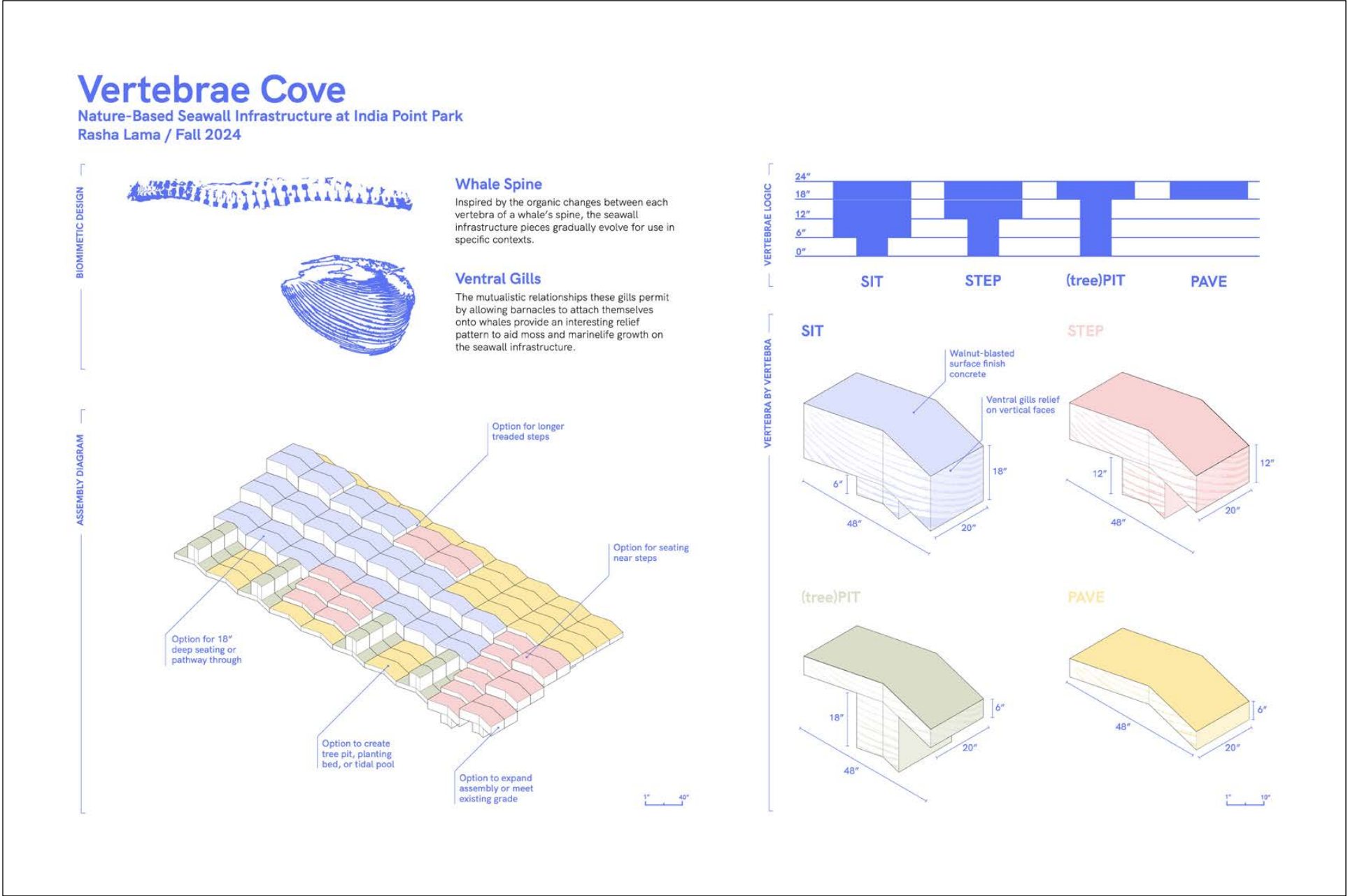
Vertebrae Cove proposes a biomimetic modular seawall infrastructure derived from whale vertebrae at India Point Park.



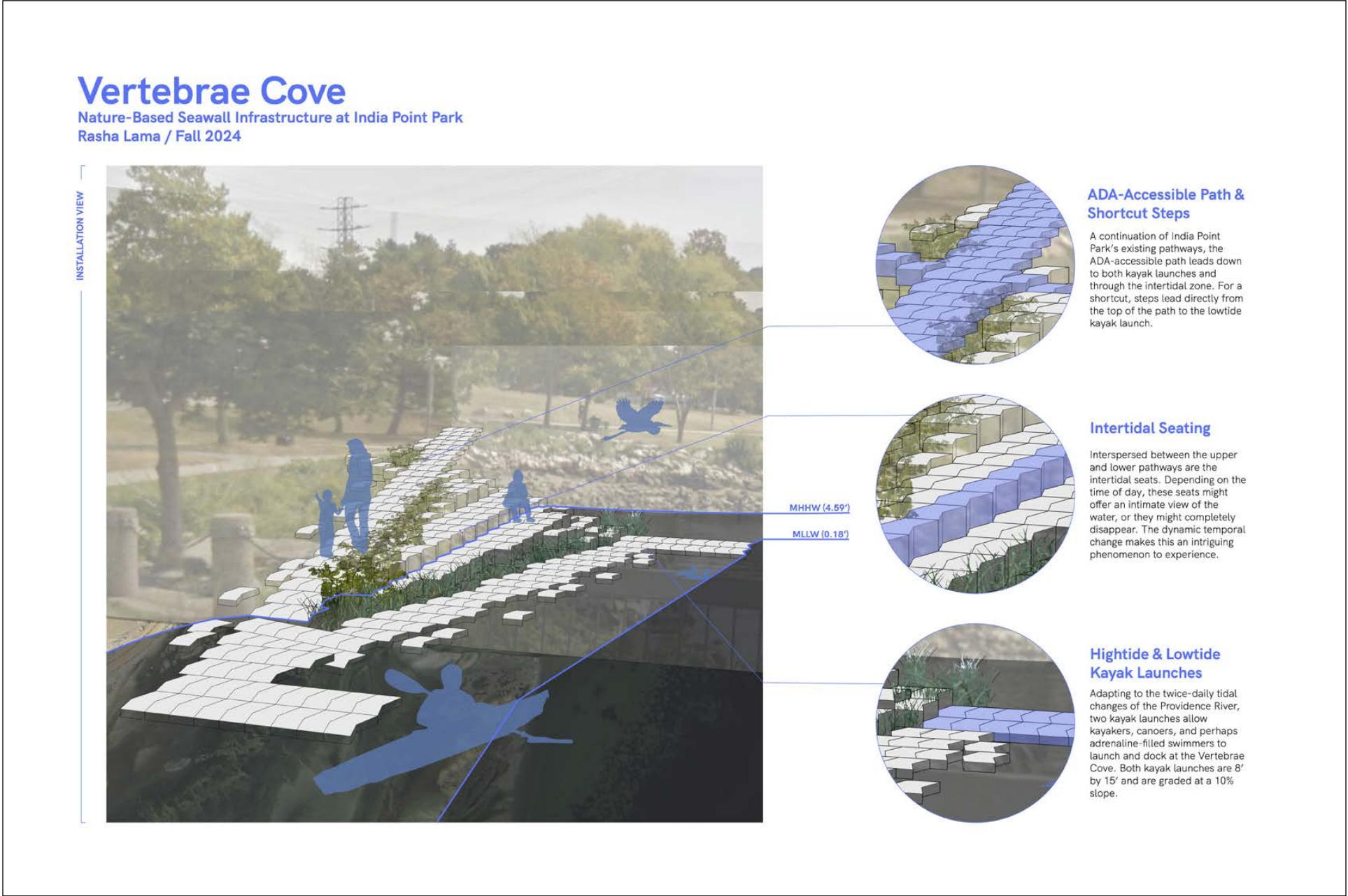
Lowtide Kayak Launch Model (1:2).



Proposed Plan (1:10) & Site Condition Sections (1:2).



Biomimetic Design, Vertebrae Logic, & Assembly Diagram.



Installation Render & Programmatic Features.

Title

Location

Statement

Québec on Film

Various regions of Québec, Canada

An experiment in context, a body is built through the textures of landscapes. Stripped of context, the landscape adopts a new narrative, a narrative equally dependent on the foreign environment as on the witnesser responding to the phenomena.

In a similar arrangement, I find myself occupying ground between my native place and my expatriate space, unsure where my true identity begins and ends.



Experiment in White. Collaging various landscapes into one “body” using photographs taken in various across Québec and Ontario.



Parc national du Fjord-du-Saguenay. August 2020, 6-hour drive from Montréal, 2-night stay.



Parc national du Bic. October 2022, 5-hour drive from Montréal, 1-night stay.



Rivière-au-Renard-Ouest of Gaspésie. January/February 2021, 10-hour drive from Montréal, 14-night stay.



Centre d'Art Marcel Gagnon of Sainte-Flavie. En-route to Gaspésie.



